

Hesam Teymouri Athar, Ph.D.

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Marketing <i>Oklahoma State University, Spears School of Business</i> Committee Members: Dr. Steven Shepherd, Dr. Todd Arnold, Dr. Tom J. Brown	2019 – 2023
Master's in Marketing <i>University of Tehran, School of Management</i>	2015 – 2018
B.Sc. in Mechanical Engineering <i>Science and Research University of Tehran</i>	2010 – 2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Consumer–Technology Interactions (AI Systems, Service Technologies, Digital Platforms); Retail and Service Experience Design; Customer Dissatisfaction

PUBLISHED RESEARCH

Teymouri Athar, H., & Shepherd, S. (2026). It's not MY job! Consumer entitlement and responses to self-service technologies. *Journal of Services Marketing*, Vol. ahead-of-print. <https://doi.org/10.1108/JSM-01-2025-0048> 

Shepherd, S., Teymouri Athar, H., & Zaboli, S. (2024). On the political right, the customer is always right: Political ideology, entitlement, and complaining. *Journal of Consumer Psychology*, 34, 83–91. <https://doi.org/10.1002/jcpy.1366> 

UNDER-REVIEW RESEARCH

Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Shepherd, Sahel Zaboli, “The Hands-On Effect: How Retail Donation Design Impacts Prosocial Behavior,” (*Journal of Business Research - Invited for 2nd round review*)

Summary: This research shows that thoughtfully designed retail donation formats can significantly enhance consumer prosocial behavior, including donation likelihood, future commitment, and social sharing. By identifying the cognitive and affective mechanisms underlying these effects, the findings provide retailers with evidence-based guidance for designing donation programs that build authentic consumer engagement and long-term brand goodwill.

WORKING PAPERS

Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Rayburn, Mayoor Mohan, “Trapped by Technology: How Agentic AI Shapes Service Captivity” (available upon request)

Status: Preparing for Submission (Target: *Journal of Marketing*)

Summary: This research investigates how agentic AI systems heighten consumers' feelings of service captivity — constrained choice, voice, and power. Drawing on Self-Determination Theory, four preregistered experiments (N = 1,490) show that AI agents replacing human judgment frustrate core psychological needs, reducing satisfaction, loyalty, and word-of-mouth. A large-scale archival study (N = 2.4 million) further validates these effects using RoBERTa-large machine learning text classification, showing captivity expressions increase systematically with financial service automation. The findings offer actionable guidance for designing more psychologically supportive algorithmic systems.

Hesam Teymouri Athar, “The Social Roles of Artificial Intelligence: A Computational Literature Review and BERTopic Modeling Approach”

Status: Data Collection In Progress (Target: *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*)

Summary: This paper introduces the AI Role Construal (ARC) framework, proposing that consumers assign four social roles to AI systems — partner, supervisor, judge, and gatekeeper — based on perceived psychological distance. Grounded in Construal Level Theory, the framework explains how interface cues, domain characteristics, and consumer dispositions activate role construals that shape trust, fairness, autonomy threat, and behavior. A systematic literature review and unsupervised BERTopic machine learning topic modeling provide theoretical grounding and computational validation of the taxonomy.

Mohammad Pasham, **Hesam Teymouri Athar**, Todd J. Arnold, "The Right Tip at The Right Time: Redefining Tip Prompts Through Construal-Level Theory"

Status: 4th Data Collection Round (Target: *Journal of Service Research*)

Summary: This research applies Construal Level Theory to examine how the timing and framing of digital tip prompts shape consumer generosity. We demonstrate that pre-service prompts evoke high-level construal and reduce evaluability, while post-service prompts elicit low-level construal and enhance evaluability. The findings reveal that aligning the temporal presentation of tipping cues with consumers' construal mindset can optimize generosity and improve digital service design.

Sahel Zaboli, **Hesam Teymouri Athar**, Steven Shepherd, "Ethics in the Spotlight: Brand Moral Transgression and Consumer Moral Grandstanding"

Status: Writing Manuscript (Target: *Journal of Consumer Psychology*)

Summary: This paper investigates how individuals use public moral expression as a form of status-seeking through *moral grandstanding*, and how this shapes distinct forms of consumer activism, buycotting, boycotting, and canceling. It distinguishes between *prestige* (admiration-seeking) and *dominance* (assertion through shaming) motives, showing that these pathways predict whether consumers engage in supportive (buycotting) or punitive (canceling) actions in response to brand moral transgressions. The findings offer practical insights for brands navigating reputational risks, highlighting when moral backlash or support is likely based on the underlying motivations of consumers.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Digital Marketing; Marketing Research; Marketing Analytics; Marketing Strategy; Service Marketing; Principles of Marketing

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor of Practice (NTT), University of New Haven (3-3 load) 08/2025 – Present
Connecticut, USA

- Digital Marketing Strategy (MBA) - 21 students
- Digital Marketing - 24 students
- Principles of Marketing - 36 students

Visiting Instructor, Beijing Wuzi University 05/2025 – 06/2025
Beijing, China

- Principles of Marketing - 78 students
- Principles of Marketing - 75 students

Instructor, University of New Haven (3-3 load) 2024 – 2025
Connecticut, USA

- Digital Marketing Strategy (MBA) - 35 students
- Digital Marketing Strategy (MBA) - 43 students
- Digital Marketing (undergraduate) - 29 students
- Digital Marketing (undergraduate) - 32 students
- Principles of Marketing - 27 students
- Principles of Marketing - 35 students

Instructor, University of New Haven (3-3 load) 2023 – 2024
Connecticut, USA

- Digital Marketing Strategy (MBA) - 18 students
- Digital Marketing - 21 undergraduate students
- Digital Marketing - 42 MBA and undergraduate students
- Market Analysis and Customer Value (MBA) - 32 students
- Principles of Marketing - 44 students
- Principles of Marketing - 39 students

Instructor, Oklahoma State University (Fall 2022/Spring 2023) 2022 – 2023
Oklahoma, USA

- Principles of Marketing - 114 undergraduate students
- Principles of Marketing - 85 undergraduate students

CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOPS

Will Present - Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Rayburn, Mayoor Mohan, "Trapped by Technology: How Agentic AI Shapes Service Captivity," *Summer AMA conference*, Denver, CO, 2026

Will Present - Sahel Zaboli, Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Shepherd, "Moral Grandstanding in Consumer Activism: Prestige and Dominance Pathways to Buycotting, Boycotting, and Canceling," *Summer AMA conference*, Denver, CO, 2026

Will Present - Mohammad Pasham, Hesam Teymouri Athar, Todd J. Arnold, "The Right Tip at The Right Time: Redefining Tip Prompts Through Construal-Level Theory," *Academy of Marketing Science conference*, Savannah, GA, 2026

Presented - Sahel Zaboli, Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Shepherd, "Ethics in the Spotlight: Brand Moral Transgression and Consumer Moral Grandstanding," *Society for Consumer Psychology (SCP)*, San Diego, CA, 2026

Presented - Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Shepherd, "Engaging Generosity: How retail Donation Designs Influence Charitable Behavior," *Winter AMA conference*, Phoenix, AZ, 2025

Served (roundtable) - "Emerging Technologies and Consumer Well-being: Peril and Promise," Meryl P. Gardner and Ainslie Schultz, *Association for Consumer Research (ACR)*, Seattle, WA, 2023

Presented - Steven Shepherd, Hesam Teymouri Athar, Sahel Zaboli, "On the Political Right, the Customer is Always Right: Political Ideology, Entitlement, and Complaining," *Society for Consumer Psychology (SCP)*, San Juan, PR, 2023

Presented - Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Shepherd, "Customer Entitlement: What makes entitled customers use self-serve tech in a service environment," *Winter AMA conference*, Nashville, TN, 2023

Presented - Hesam Teymouri Athar, Steven Shepherd, "New technology introduction in the frontline: the role of customers' political ideology," *Summer AMA conference*, Chicago, IL, 2022

Participated - Marketing & Public Policy Pre-Conference Doctoral Research Workshop, *Baylor University*, June 2022

ACADEMIC SERVICES & MEMBERSHIPS

Faculty Advisor <i>Marketing Club & AMA chapter, University of New Haven</i>	2026
Association for Consumer Research (ACR) Conference <i>Ad Hoc Reviewer</i>	2026
Journal of Services Marketing <i>Ad Hoc Reviewer - Special issue on the intersection of service research and public policy</i>	2026
AACSB Assurance of Learning (AOL) Committee <i>University of New Haven</i>	2025 – present
Journal of Public Policy & Marketing <i>Trainee Reviewer - Supervisor: Dr. Kristen L. Walker</i>	2024 – present
Association for Consumer Research (ACR) Conference <i>Ad Hoc Reviewer</i>	2025
American Marketing Association <i>Member</i>	2025 – present
Faculty Development Committee Member <i>University of New Haven</i>	2024 – present
Undergraduate & Accelerated MBA Student Adviser <i>University of New Haven (35+ students)</i>	2023 – present
Academy of Marketing Science (AMS) Annual Conference <i>Ad Hoc Reviewer</i>	2024
American Marketing Association (AMA) Winter Conference <i>Ad Hoc Reviewer</i>	2023
Vice-Chair of International Relations <i>AMA Doctoral Students Interest Group (DocSIG)</i>	2021 – 2023
Executive chair <i>Doctoral Students Association, Spears School of Business, Oklahoma State University</i>	2020 – 2023
Vice-President <i>International Student Organization, Oklahoma State University</i>	2020 – 2022
JMR Scholarly Insights writer for AMA website Hesam Teymouri (2021), "Surprise! When regulations backfire because of politics" JMR scholarly insights by DocSig ☑	2021

HONORS AND GRANTS

Spears School of Business Alumni Merit Award	02/2023
Graduate College Robberson Research and Creative Activity Grant (\$2500)	07/2022
RIATA Center Business Plan Competition Finalist., Oklahoma State University (\$1000)	11/2020
Top-Tier Fellowship, Oklahoma State University (\$6000)	08/2019

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

Digital Product Developer (iOS Mobile Application) - Independent Project | 2023–2024

- Developed a mobile app integrating marketing strategy and UX design.
- Applied data-driven and behavioral insights to improve user experience and engagement.
- Led a team of engineers to enhance product performance and user experience.

B2B Sales & Marketing Consultant - Mediana Co. | 2016–2018

- Initiated and built a high-performing sales team of 13 representatives, focused on B2B digital marketing solutions.
- Led sales efforts for SMS and email marketing platforms, contributing to revenue growth and client acquisition.
- Designed digital customer journeys by initiating, designing, and implementing an integrated CRM system.
- Collaborated on Search Engine Optimization (SEO) initiatives to boost web traffic and lead generation.
- Implemented clustering-based customer segmentation to refine targeting and optimize outreach for B2B digital marketing solutions.

Sales & Marketing Expert and Student Adviser - MBA Department - Mahan Business School | 2014–2015

- Served as the primary salesperson for educational services, including GMAT and other exam preparation courses and mock tests.
- Advised over 40 students on curriculum planning, test preparation, and academic progression.
- Designed and managed digital marketing campaigns to increase website traffic and generate qualified leads.

SKILLS AND METHODS

Methods: Experiment Design, Natural Language Processing (NLP), Machine Learning Text Classification, Transformer Model Fine-Tuning (RoBERTa), Large Language Model (LLM) Text Annotation, Choice-Based Conjoint Analysis, Multilevel Modeling (Mixed-Effects Models), Difference-in-Differences, Hierarchical Clustering, K-Means, Dimensionality Reduction (PCA), RFM Analysis, Price Elasticity Modeling, Deep Neural Networks (Transformer Architecture), Systematic literature review (PRISMA)

Tools: Python (PyTorch, HuggingFace Transformers, pandas, scikit-learn), R (data.table, lme4, AER, http2, ggplot2), SPSS, SQL, Survey Design Tools, Figma, UI/UX Design, AI Tools, Digital Marketing Tools, Web Design

CERTIFICATES

Customer Analytics in Python Udemy (2024)	WordPress Udemy (2023)	Machine Learning with Knime Udemy (2023)
Complete Digital Marketing Course Udemy (2023)	Fundamentals of Digital Marketing Google Digital Garage (2022)	The Ultimate MySQL Bootcamp Udemy (2022)
Data Science A-Z Udemy (2022)	Programming for everybody University of Michigan (Coursera) (2021)	Python Data Structures University of Michigan (Coursera) (2021)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Immigration & U.S. Work Authorization Status: Permanent Residence in the United States (i.e., Green Card) - No H-1B Visa Sponsorship Needed

Hobbies: Football, Photography, Hiking, Foosball, Playing Guitar, Feeding Stray Cats